

2026/27

Travel

Coaches Guide



Some Responsibilities

- Send introductory email to team
- Manage being late or absences with the help of the other staff members - let the other coaches on your field know to cover for you. **If missing a practice, please let me know.**
 - Help each other out in these situations.
- Use the allotted practice space, unless discussed with others.
- Be fair about usage of mini and large goals in the week- they are not first come first serve - be cognizant of this.
- Provide Winter Season Feedback and Postseason Feedback (a process I will help with)
- Ensure playtime requirements are met (chart shown later)
- Show up to games 45 minutes early. Always notify the team promptly if you will be later than this.
- Maintain the standards of our **club identity, philosophies, and methodology.**
 - ARCS, Style/Principles of Play, Session structure

Non-Negotiables

- Do not cancel or move training sessions to new locations. Must have prior approval.
- Players / families are not pressured to do additional training and activities.
 - Showing up earlier for extra practice communicated to a team.
 - All outside events are optional.
- Players / families will not be charged for extra things in any association with their velocity team. It cannot be related to their experience at Velocity.
 - Private training for a specific team
 - Team cameras
 - Extra gear / tools
- Yelling / being aggressive toward referees, opposing and fellow coaches, or any of the players

Mandatory Playing Time Guidelines

Playing time guidelines are a core part of our club philosophy and are expected to be followed consistently by all coaches

Age Group	U7/U8	U9-U10	U11-U12	U13-U14	U15-U16	U17-U19
Minimum Playing Time And Starts	Playing time is distributed evenly to all players in each game.	Playing time is distributed evenly to all players in each game but can be adjusted if the game situation requires it but playing time is at least 50 % of the time in each game. Players take turns starting, and no one starts on the bench two games in a row.	Every player plays at least 50 % of the time in each game and should receive at least 50% starts on average over a month.	Every player plays at least 50 % of the time in each game and should receive at least 50% starts on average over a month if she attends all games and practices.	Every players starts at least 40% of the games over the course of the season if she attends all games and practices,	Every players starts at least 25% of the games over the course of the season if she attends all games and practices.

The perceived ability of a player should NEVER be used as an excuse to justify missing the guidelines above. The only factors that can justify missing the guidelines above are the health of the player (e.g. return from injury) and behavior that goes dramatically and/or repetitive against Virginia Velocity Core Values and Principles.



I am here to help



- Guidance and support on
 - Session design / improving the players
 - Behavioral concerns of players or parents
 - Managing games, subs and strategies to balance learning and competitiveness of team
- **Open to chat every Friday from 10am-12pm** - Coffee chats, I will send out a link. or we can meet in person from time to time.
- [THE COACH'S PAGE](#) - Updated with articles, PDFs, and other resources to help you.

A photograph of four young soccer players in black uniforms with white stripes on the sleeves and shorts, celebrating on a grassy field. The player on the far right is shouting with his mouth wide open, while the others are also smiling and looking towards him. The background is blurred, showing other players and spectators. The text "Club Identity" is overlaid in the center in a large, bold, black font.

Club Identity

Our Purpose

MISSION

To provide a happier, healthier life to our members through meaningful learning moments, peak experiences, lifelong memories and love for soccer.

"I always see football for what it is and what it should be. A match where anything can happen. The players, 90 minutes, fantastic moves, an element of luck, talent, courage, a touch of magic and for those that are watching these men play, the search for excitement, for a memory, for a lesson in life."

Arsene Wenger

Club Philosophy

We put the love for soccer and the happiness of the child at the forefront of all our interactions.

We firmly believe that a genuine passion for soccer is the most critical ingredient in a player's learning journey, regardless of their age. This inherent love for the game serves as a driving force for self-motivation, leading players to engage more enthusiastically with the sport, practice at home, and persevere through challenges and setbacks. When players genuinely love what they do, their improvement accelerates significantly.

We are here for the players and not the other way around. Our approach revolves around giving players the freedom to express themselves fully on the field and support them in becoming the best version of themselves. We believe that this is the optimal way for players to learn and develop.

Creating a safe and empowering environment is of utmost importance to us. We foster strong relationships between players, coaches, parents, and staff, ensuring that each individual feels supported and valued.

We embrace the players' desire and will to win by holding each other accountable to doing our best. When we do our best in practice, we will develop faster. When we do our best in games, we will have a higher chance of winning.

"Young players today grow up in a completely different world than my days in Amsterdam. But the game is the same. It should be about what it was about for us back then – fun."

Johan Cruyff

Core Values

Virginia Velocity has five Core Values that are grounded in our Club Philosophy. These values shape our actions and behavior, creating an enjoyable and safe environment where all players, coaches, and parents are working together towards excellence.

ENJOYMENT

We foster a love for the game by creating a fun, engaging, and stimulating soccer experience. Children who love what they do develop faster.

RESPECT

We treat coaches, teammates, opponents, officials, and the game itself with dignity and fairness. By promoting good sportsmanship, integrity, accountability, and a positive attitude towards others, we will create a safe and supportive environment for our members.

EMPOWERMENT

We foster autonomy, self-confidence, and personal growth by providing our members a voice in their soccer journey. By embracing unique identities and valuing their perspectives we nurture authenticity.

BELONGING

We create an inclusive environment where everybody feels accepted, valued, and part of a team. Our welcoming atmosphere fosters a shared purpose, boosts confidence, and enhances member experiences.

EXCELLENCE

We encourage the pursuit of excellence through challenges in healthy and respectful competition. By acknowledging winning as part of the developmental process but not the only measure of it, we accelerate personal growth.



Core Principles



Our Core Principles shape our actions and behavior.

We believe that if we follow our Core Principles at all times, we will create an enjoyable and safe environment where all players, coaches and parents are working together, and in which excellence will flourish.

1. DO YOUR BEST

In everything we do, we will do our best: at practice, in games, or in other activities. As a result, our teams will be stronger and individual improvement will occur more quickly. Challenging our limits will allow us to eventually push through them and reach new heights. When we all do our best as players and as teammates, we maximize our chances of winning games.

2. BE RESPECTFUL TO EVERYONE

We strive to be respectful to everyone we interact with. If we are respectful with each other, we help to create a safe environment in which everyone is empowered to make his voice heard. As a result, we will become more connected and our environment as a whole becomes more enjoyable and conducive to growth and development.

3. BE THE BEST TEAMMATE YOU CAN BE

Good teammates create good teams. The best teammates create the best teams. Good players working together as a team often win games against better players who are not working together. Therefore, if everybody is the best teammate they can be, our team and club will be better and we have a better chance of winning more games. A stronger team, where all players support and help each other, is also more fun to be part of.

4. COMMUNICATE WITH EACH OTHER

Virginia Velocity players, coaches and parents are open, honest, and timely in our communication with each other. If we all communicate this way, we know more about one another and as such have a deeper connection to one another. Teams that are more connected this way tend to have better relationships and stick together when times are tough--which leads to better results on the field.

5. DON'T MAKE EXCUSES

Virginia Velocity players and coaches recognize that excuses are impediments to growth. The moment we make an excuse, we surrender a problem's outcome to someone else instead of taking responsibility for being a part of the solution. Growth happens because of mistakes, and when we own our mistakes, we own our growth.



Soccer Philosophy



Soccer Philosophy



We believe that the game of soccer is a complex, unpredictable, and chaotic game, played by complex human beings.

Teams and players follow a collective purpose like the Virginia Velocity's Style of Play, but will always have individual freedom contributing to this collective purpose. Players are always encouraged to adapt to the environment they are in.

STYLE OF PLAY

Virginia Velocity's style of play is centered around **our love for the ball and scoring goals.**

We want our teams to **display an attacking intent that is built on courageous, purposeful, and penetrative possession.**

We want our teams to recover the ball as a team, **starting recovery actions as close to the opponent goal as possible, demonstrating high intensity and discipline to regain possession as fast as possible.**

We want to play the game in a way, that **supports individual players to express their strengths** and make **independent** decisions that positively impact the collective.

Philosophy On Players

ADAPTABLE

We embrace the fact that no game situation will ever be the same. We exhibit adaptability by adjusting to the evolving game, paying close attention to teammates' decisions and opponents' strategies. We will make effective decisions by looking for advantages and solutions to win the game.

BRAVE

We demonstrate bravery by fearlessly taking on challenges and embracing the opportunity to compete. We take risks and show courage and resilience in the face of adversity, always striving to make a positive impact on the game. We take the initiative and possess the confidence to express ourselves knowing that we have the support of teammates, coaches and families.

CONNECTED

We understand that a connected team is stronger than the sum of its parts. We work together as a cohesive, unified unit by supporting each other on and off the field. We create memorable experiences together through strong relationships, trust, and a shared sense of purpose.

UNIQUE

We celebrate our uniqueness and value our individual identities and contributions to the team, which collectively create a diverse and vibrant soccer style. Our creativity will flourish through our own flair, skill and personality while respecting and appreciating the uniqueness of our teammates.

Game Phases and Principles

For each phase we use main principles that allow us to describe the behavior of the players on the field. These principles provide our coaching staff with a common language to observe, analyze and explain what is happening in the game.

Players juggle all principles at the same time, constantly adapting their next interaction based on the changing environment. The relationship between principles is ***heterarchical*** - meaning no single principle always comes first. Instead, players flexibly shift which principle takes priority depending on the situation.

This fluidity supports adaptive decision-making and reflects the dynamic, complex nature of the game.

In Possession - Attacking

Score A Goal

Play Forward

Keep Control
Of The Ball

Out Of Possession - Defending

Defend the
Goal

Deny Forward

Go Win The
Ball Back

In Possession Principles

Score a Goal

Play Forward

**Keep Control Of The
Ball**

Organize to, and Play Around, Through, or Over the Opponent by finding, creating and using spaces

Guiding
Question
Examples

Who is most
able to score in
the moment?

What can you do to
become more
threatening?

How can you help
our team keep
control of the ball?
Who can help you?

What else can you
do to help our
team?

Key Attacking Interactions:
Off-ball-Movements, Finishing,
Dribbling, Turning,
Decept/fake/surprise, Protecting,
Passing, Crossing

Dribble, Wall-Pass,

Out Of Possession Principles

Defend the Goal

Deny Forward Options

Go Win The Ball Back

Organize to prevent the opponent from playing Through, Over, or Around by closing spaces.

Guiding
Question
Examples

What space is most
important to defend
in this moment?

Who do you need to
be aware of and
adjust to?

How are you
helping your team
with where you are
positioned?

Where will the ball
go and what will you
do next?

Key Defending Interactions: Marking,
Shot-Blocking, Tracking, Rebounding,
Closing, Intercepting, Dropping, Tackling,
Clearing, Jockeying, Fouling,
Decept/Fake/Surprise



Training Methodology



Methodology Objective



The **Virginia Velocity FC Methodology** is the framework that guides how we train and develop players.

It ensures that our approach is intentional, consistent, and rooted in our philosophy of putting the individual child at the center of everything we do.

It guides us into creating an environment where players can most efficiently, and meaningfully learn the game of soccer.

Training Philosophy

We believe that training is the most influential preparation for competition. We believe that during training, all players must be exposed to realistic game situations to help in their development and to properly prepare them for competition.

We believe that training should focus on a simultaneous development of all players abilities within them. Players will best develop when being exposed to a training environment that offers variable situations with a lot of uncertainty, that provides ample opportunities for players to make decisions (solve problems) and that requires players to optimize themselves according to the need of the situation.

We believe in a training environment that promotes a more active participation of the player and involves less prescriptive teaching methods by the coach. **Players are encouraged to take ownership in their own development and the coach is encouraged to promote the players ability to adapt.**

*"No man can walk through
the same river twice, for it is
not the same river, nor the
same man."
Heraclitus*

*"The gardener cannot actually
"grow" tomatoes, squash, or
beans – she can only foster an
environment in which the plants
do so."
Stanley McChrystal*

Foundational Research

SELF-DETERMINATION THEORY

We want players to love the game and take charge of their journey. That means creating an environment where they feel:

- **Autonomy** (they have a say)
- **Competence** (they feel growth)
- **Connection** (they feel part of a team/club/community)

Ryan, R. M., & Deci, E. L. (2000).

Title: *Self-Determination Theory and the Facilitation of Intrinsic Motivation, Social Development, and Well-Being.*
Journal: *American Psychologist*, 55(1), 68–78.

ECOLOGICAL DYNAMICS

A more holistic approach to development.

Ecological dynamics is a theory of how people learn skills and make decisions through real-time interactions with their environment. It sees athletes and their surroundings as one connected system, where actions emerge from constantly adapting to the situation. Skill is not something you have - it's something you do, in context.

Skills aren't just repeated patterns. Instead of repeating the same move, you adapt your movements each time based on the fact that no problem is ever the exact same, so neither is the functional solution. This is called “repetition without repetition”.

Seifert, L., Button, C., & Davids, K. (2013).

Title: *Key properties of expert movement systems in sport: An ecological dynamics perspective.*

Journal: *Sports Medicine*, 43(3), 167–178.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s40279-012-0011-z>

NON LINEAR APPROACH TO TEACHING AND LEARNING

- Representative Learning Design
- Repetition Without Repetition
- Constraints Manipulation

Constraints are anything that shapes or limits how a person behaves, moves, or solves problems.

There are 3 Types of constraints: As coaches - we primarily manipulate **Task** constraints to guide learning outcomes.

1. **Individual:** Who they are, and what they are capable of. Ex: Intentions, emotions, height capabilities, etc
2. **Task:** What practice tasks they are participating in. Ex: opponents, teammates, rules, the ball, etc
3. **Environment:** "Where" it's happening. Ex: Surfaces, weather, cultural values, traditions, etc.

Renshaw, I., Chow, J. Y., Davids, K., & Hammond, J. (2010).

Title: *A Constraints-Led Perspective to Understanding Skill Acquisition and Game Play: A Basis for Integration of Motor Learning Theory and Physical Education Praxis.*

Journal: *Physical Education and Sport Pedagogy*, 15(2), 117–137.

4 TRAINING PILLARS - ARCS

ATHLETIC-BASE: *MOVE*

Coordination with and without the ball.

RESILIENCE: *PERSIST*

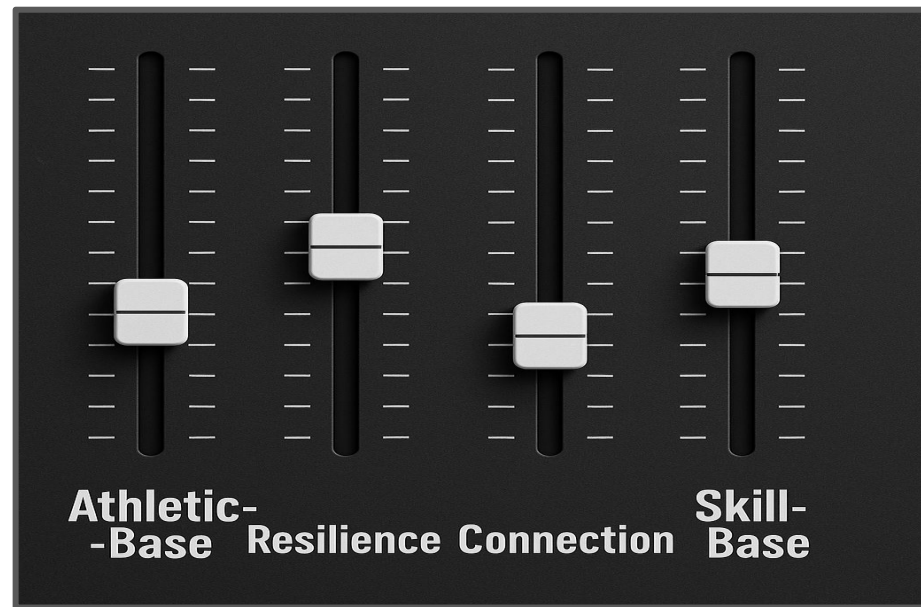
Emotional Control, Mental Flexibility, and Growth Through Struggle.

CONNECTION: *BELONG*

Social-bonding, Autonomy with responsibility.

SKILL-BASE: *ADAPT*

The functional adaptive relationship between an athlete and their environment.



Athletic-Base: Move

Developing Physical Literacy

- An **Athletic-Base** is best developed through playful activities that encourage challenging repetitions of explorative motor-control problem solving.
- An **Athletic-Base** = coordination, dexterity, balance, and agility across a range of tasks with and without the ball.
 - Adaptable in how they run, kick, hop, landing, catch, roll, crawl, balance, stop/start, spin, slide, dodge, etc
 - A close relationship- “Me and The Ball” seen in how the ball is controlled no matter the situation or where it comes from: On the ground, in the air, left or right, behind or beside, different heights, spins, and speeds - all are manageable.
 - Enhances creativity, prevents injury, and increases confidence and joy.
 - Leads to increased neuroplasticity - helping players form adaptable brain-body-environment connections that promote long-term skill learning.



Sample Activities

- **Tag Games** - With and without the ball - varieties and challenges are endless.
- **Relay Race Challenges & Obstacle Courses** – Can jumping, crawling, and rolling - passes, dribbles, moves etc - with and without the ball.
- **Mirroring / External Response Games** – 1v1 shadowing - try and copy exactly what the other is doing. Or dribbling / stopping after certain cues (coach call outs or hand gestures)
- **Keepaway Tag** – Tagging replaces tackling in a passing game.
- **Movement Challenges** – Ex: Patterns, juggling, “moves”, and more that challenges the players to move / do things with the ball that are challenging.
- **Duels** – Line balance, tug-of-wars, bear wrestling, 1v1 type activities.

Rudd, J., Renshaw, I., Savelsbergh, G. J. P., Chow, J. Y., Roberts, W. M., Newcombe, D., & Davids, K. (2021). *Nonlinear Pedagogy and the Athletic Skills Model: The importance of play in supporting physical literacy*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003025375>

Resilience: Persist

Emotional Control, Mental Flexibility, and Growth Through Struggle

Resilience is a process of learning to regulate emotions, persist through challenge, and adapt under pressure by engaging in **game-like, emotionally meaningful experiences**.

Resilience isn't built through comfort and ease, it emerges through in manageable struggle. Players grow by coping with uncertainty, responding to setbacks, and solving problems in emotionally stimulating environments.

Resilience-designed environments offer **challenge, choice, and safe failure**, building the emotional and cognitive tools needed for learning, performance, and life.

Benefits

- **Increased focus and frustration tolerance**
- **Improved decision-making under pressure**
- **Stronger self-belief and autonomy**
- **Long-term motivation and love for the game**

Use game rules, or other activities to challenge players emotionally and cognitively: How can we develop and encourage resilience?

- “Winners stay, losers drop”
- Affirmations and reward for those who exemplify resilient behavior
- Challenge matches (weaker vs stronger teams)
- Playing with numbers down
- Individual role handicaps or boosts (e.g., “power player” or “individual limitations”)
- Time pressure
- Score tracking / win-loss records

Seifert, L., Komar, J., Araújo, D., & Davids, K. (2016).

Neurobiological degeneracy: A key property for functional adaptations of perception and action to constraints.

Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews, 69, 159–165.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neubiorev.2016.08.006>

Connection: Belong

Social-bonding

Connection grows in players through games and challenges that require **shared goals** and **collaborative solutions**. Elements of **Connection** exist in any activity that requires collaboration- think of a simple possession game (rondo) of 4v1, on it's own it requires collaboration- and this, and all activities can be enhanced to promote more **Connection**.

- **Relatedness and connection**
- **Communication and empathy**
- **Self-awareness and social understanding**
- **Psychological safety and trust**

Small-sided games, partner tasks, and team-based challenges help players:

- Fail without fear
- Celebrate each other's success
- Manage disappointment with **support**, not shame

Sample Activities: There are lots of things- and it depends on the age and relationships of the participants.

- **Skill Base Games** - The ways in which we design them can promote more **Connection** (See next slide for Skill-Base)
- **Co-op Games** – Challenges that can only be solved together
- **Buddy Rules** – A pass between two players before a goal, or assist-to-score
- **Tic-Tac-Total** – Goals count for extra fo every additional player involved
- **Reflection Prompts** – “Who helped you today?” “Who made your job easier?”
- **Celebration Tasks** – High-five after goals, compliment a teammate, assist tracking

Ryan, R. M., & Deci, E. L. (2000).

Title: *Self-Determination Theory and the Facilitation of Intrinsic Motivation, Social Development, and Well-Being.*
Journal: *American Psychologist*, 55(1), 68–78.

Skill-Base: Adapt

Skill is the functional adaptive relationship between an athlete and their environment. Players over the course of their development must continuously learn to “fit” into their environment. Skillful players adapt with their changing capabilities, finding success unique ways, specific to them.

Learning Skills is not the process of repeating a solution, it is the repeating the process of finding a solution. Learning is an active problem-solving process, and skill is witnessed in a player’s ability to solve whatever problems come their way with flexibility.

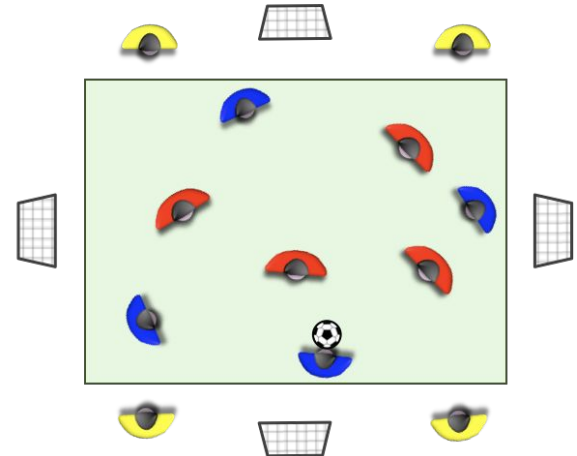
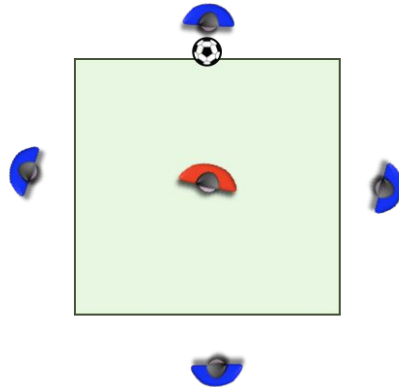
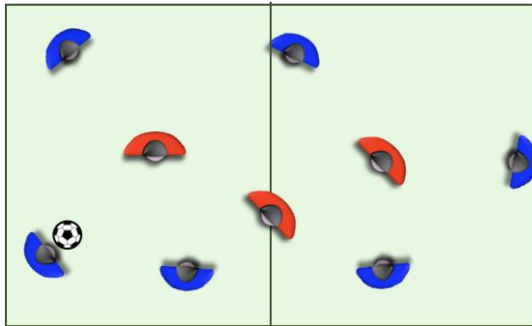
*Connection: An **Athletic Base** widens the landscape for the possibility of learning skills. Improving their action-capacity so that they have more solutions that they can find.*

Core Activity Types

- **Possession Games:** Keep-away based games, collective intentions toward maintaining control of the ball and finding ways to win the ball back.
- **Target Games:** Games with 1 or more fixed target players- Point systems involve playing into targets.
- **End-Zone Games:** “NFL” style, directional games- goals are endzones.
- **Starting point Games:** Fixed starting position activities that can isolate unique problems. 1v1s-4v4s typically.
- **Situation Games:** Role 1 vs Role 2, coordinating with teammates in a variety of situations that have opposing intentions representing a larger game context situation.
- **SSG’s and Free Play Games:** Playing soccer at smaller scales and with varying rules, spacing, & teammates.

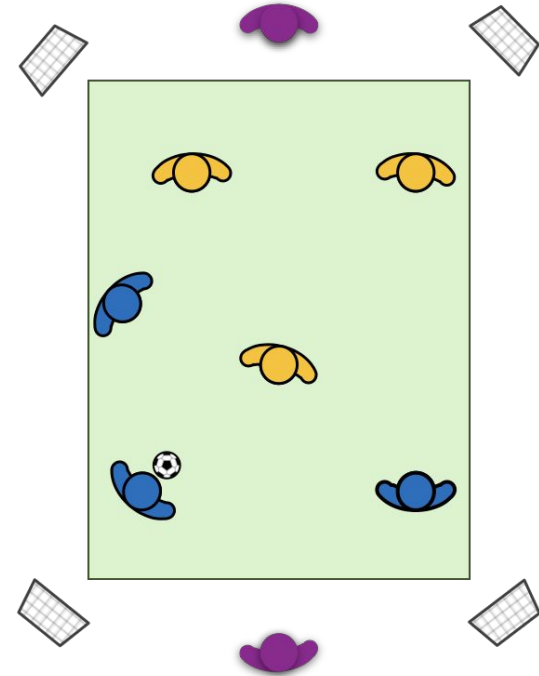
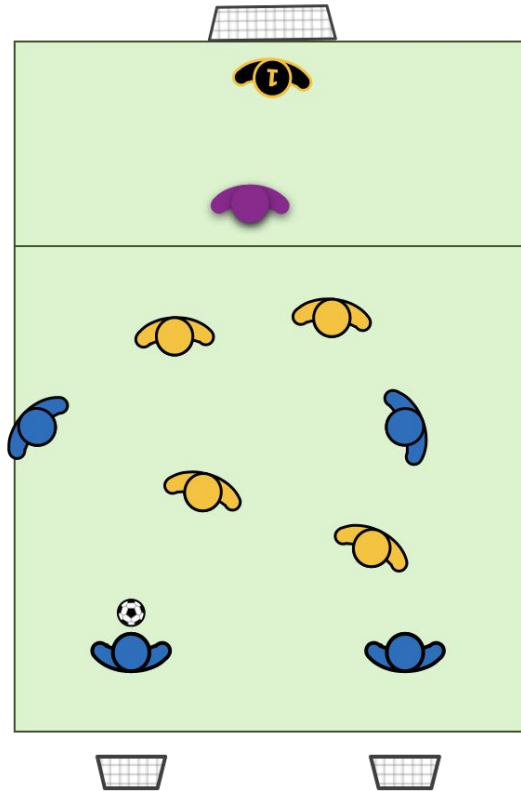
Skill-Base Training Games

Possession Games: Keep-away based games, collective intentions toward maintaining control of the ball and/or finding ways to win the ball back and score (goals or points)



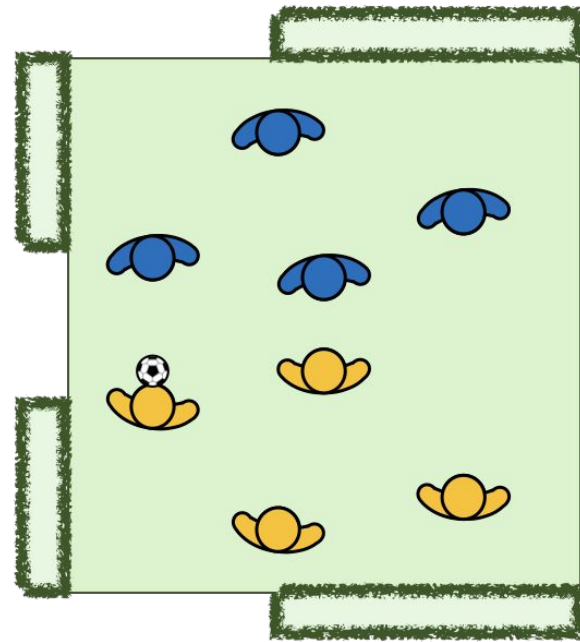
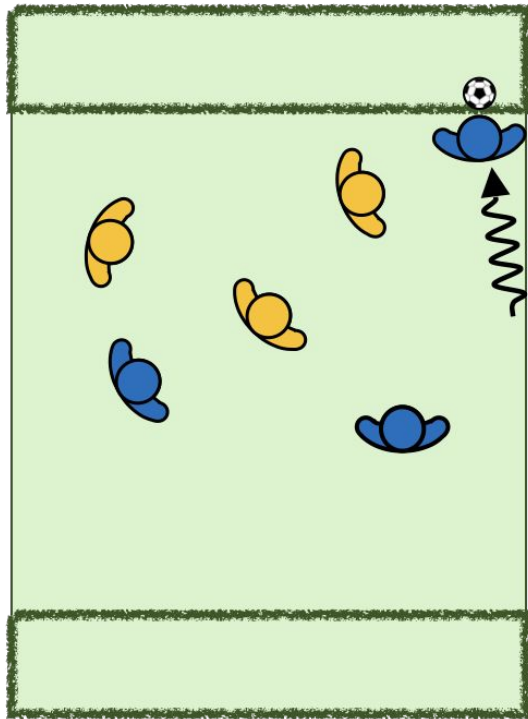
Skill-Base Training Games

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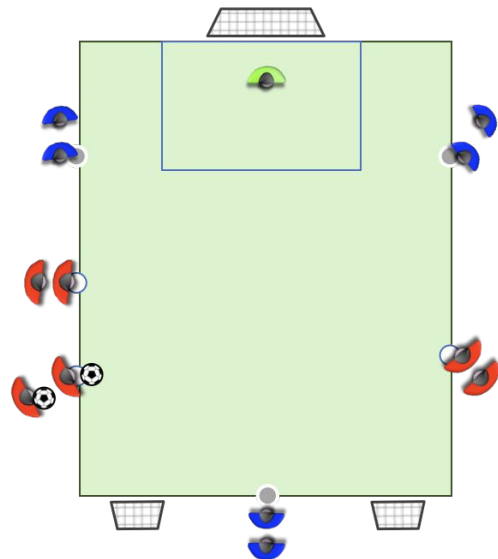
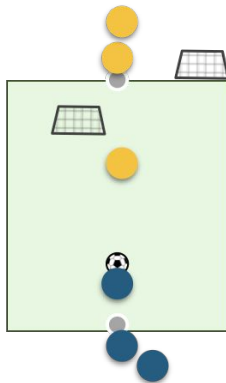
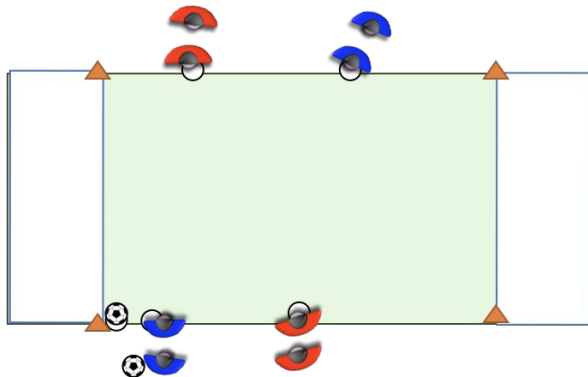
Skill-Base Training Games

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Skill-Base Training Games

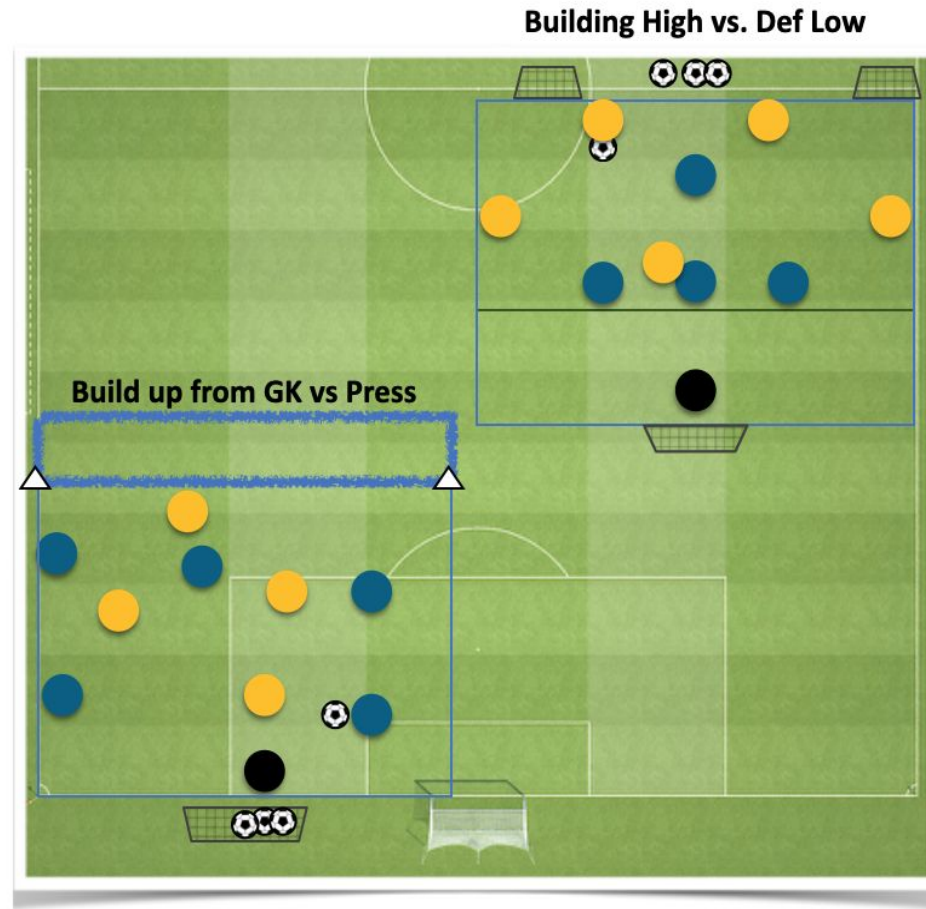
Starting point Games: Fixed starting position activities that can isolate unique problems. 1v1s-4v4s typically.



Skill-Base Training Games

Situation Games:

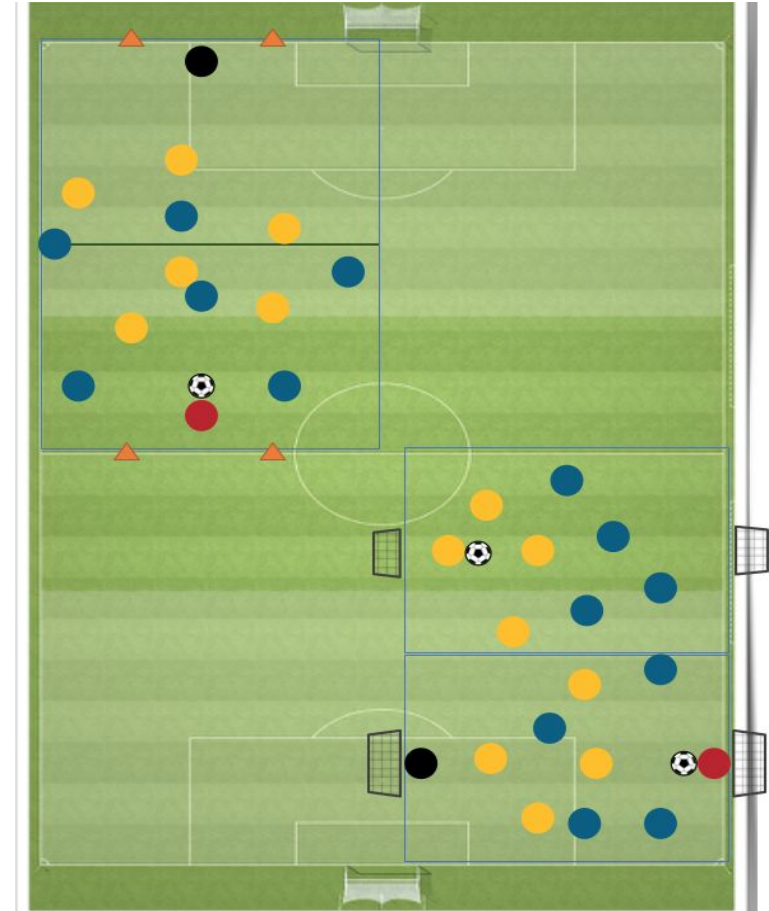
Role 1 vs Role 2, coordinating with teammates in a variety of situations that have opposing intentions representing a larger game context situation. Switch roles, mix it up.



Skill-Base Training Games

SSG's and Free Play Games:

Playing soccer at smaller scales and with varying rules, spacing, & teammates.



Coaches Toolbox - What to Adjust

Below are constraints we can use when designing / adjusting activities we can use to create conditions for efficient learning.

In general, we want to design activities toward finding an optimal challenge - hard but not too hard.

S.P.R.I.N.T.E

- **Space** – Size of dimensions, shapes, & zones. Starting positions of balls and players.
- **Players** - # of players per team, roles, teams.
- **Rules** – limits, scoring/points, zones, powerups/buffs, nerfs.
- **Interaction** – The coaching style: Asking questions, commanding, guiding, shaping intentions verbally / nonverbally.
- **Nature** – Field surface, facility, weather, climate, time of day.
- **Time** – Length of activities, shot clocks, etc.
- **Equipment** - Goals, footwear, ball, pinnies, cones.

How we **SPRINT**E can offer more repetitions/exploration related to **Athletic-Base, Skill-Base, Resilience, and Connection. (ARCS)**



Examples of Constraints & Possible Outcomes

CONSTRAINT	Possible outcomes	Possible outcomes	Possible outcomes
Numerical Inferiority.	More penetrations, dribbling, and running.	Increased the distance between teams; increased time in the lateral zones.	Greater time to perform interactions.
Numerical superiority.	Increases player distances	Less exploratory off-ball movement.	Less running for In-Possession team
Larger Goal .	Decreases player distances.	More shots and goals.	Less passing.
Small goals & End-Zones.	More spacing in possession, more dribbling penetration.	Increased defensive actions.	Increased maintenance of possession.
More scoring targets.	More spacing in possession	More shots	(The opposite happens with Less scoring targets)
First 2 touches forward for points.	Increase of tactical space behavior, more scanning, increased dribbling	More defensive behaviors pressing, tackling, marking	
Lateral (wide) zone games for points.	Increased in player distances, more crosses, passes, and attacking unity.	More defensive behaviors intercepting, marking, scanning.	
Tik-Tak-Total (# of passes or players = points if goal is scored)	Increase in player distances, and dispersal in possession.	Less dribbling, shooting and goals.	Increase in attacking unity.
Maintain possession for points.	More passes, sharing of ball, and ball touches.	Less dribbling.	Less exploratory behavior.
Shots driven on ground for points.	Increased gap/space attunement and attacking player distances.	More blocking, dribbling, shots, and intercepting.	Decrease is defending distances to close gaps.
Pass or dribble through gap for points.	Increase in gap attunement, increased scanning.	More defensive unity in closing of gaps and space, and more help-coverage	Increase of deceptive behaviors.
Field size decrease.	Increase in tactical space behavior, defensive coverage, and defensive unit	Reduced distances of both teams, increased # of interactions, more dribbling, and made decision-making difficult	Increased number of interruptions in the game, decreased effective playing time
Field size increase.	Increase In tactical balance.	Increased tactical behaviors, distances, areas occupied by the team, more team balance decisions	Decrease of on ball tactical actions per player.
Interception for point.	More scanning, anticipatory defending,	More dribbling, more pass deception.	Less passing.



Session Methodology - Regardless of Objective

25% of the session:

- ❖ **Athletic-Base Development**
 - Solving movement problems in general - not necessarily soccer decision specific.

75% of the session:

- ❖ **Skill-Base Development**
 - Solving soccer specific problems - decisions are

Build into every session somewhere

- ❖ **Resilience Development**
- ❖ **Connection Development**

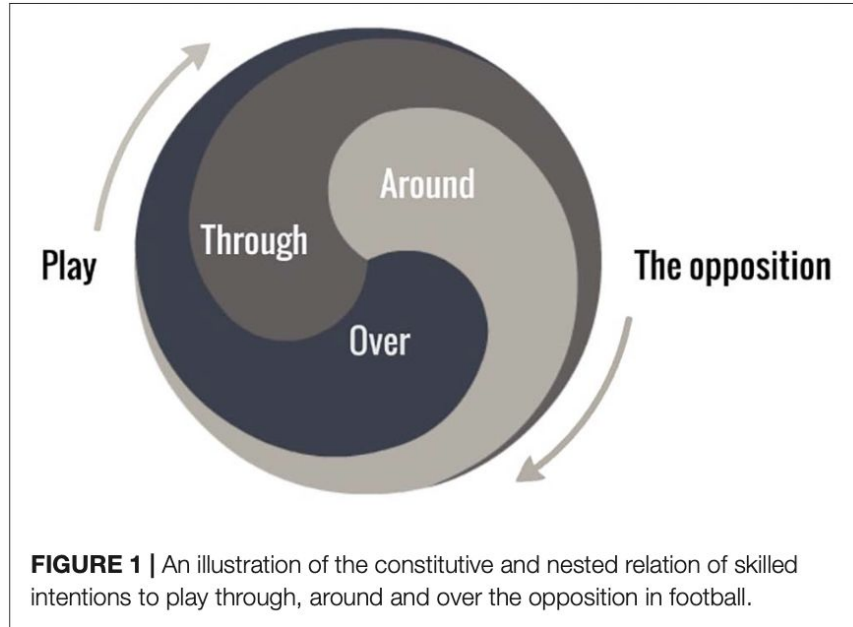
Choosing a session objective

In Possession (Attacking)

Score A Goal

Play Forward

Keep Control
Of The Ball



Out Of Possession (Defending)

Defend the
Goal

Deny Forward

Go Win The
Ball Back

Session Preparation

- Who am I coaching?
- Why are they here?
- What can I do to help them improve, and love soccer?
- What have I noticed over time with this group?
- What are my clubs objectives?

ARCS, Principles Of Play, Philosophies/Standards

Pre-Design Phase

Understanding who is in front of you

- What is the objective of my session overall?
- What are the intentions behind my activity design toward the objective?
 - If I were unable to speak, could they still learn what I want them to?
- How do my activities achieve the goal of my session overall?

Design Phase

Design with intention, set problems for the players to solve.

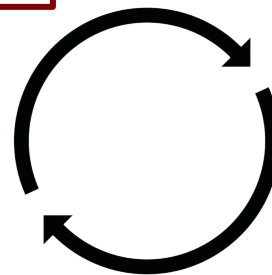
[VVFC Session Library](#)
[KNVB Session Library](#)

In-Session Coaching

- Are the players working on the things I designed the activity for?
- Is the activity too hard? Is it too easy? Boring?
- Do I need to step in and say something? Do I need to change the activity? Are they trying to find a solution to the problem?

In-Session Loop

What am I observing?



- Coaching over the flow. Asking questions, highlighting certain things they might not notice, giving feedback, reminding them what they are not paying attention to.
- Between game strategizing - having the teams get together to talk about the game.
- Freezing the activity (avoid this unless completely necessary - have you tried the first two?)

In-Session Loop

What am I doing about it?

The goal is not to solve the problem for them, but to help them solve it together.. Unless absolutely necessary.

Post Session

- Did practice help the athletes see and exploit the opportunities aligned to my activity intentions and overall session objectives?

A simple example: Objective: The players scoring lots of goals and enjoying themselves. Did the ***intentional design of activities*** make that happen?

- **If not, why not?**
How do I need to modify/adapt the practice next time?
- What did the players think about the session?
- Did the players improve throughout the session? Was it too difficult or too hard?
- If athletes solved the problems I set out for them very well, what do we need to work on next? How do I challenge the skill more?